DAEMONARCHY 1.5.X

Daemonarchy

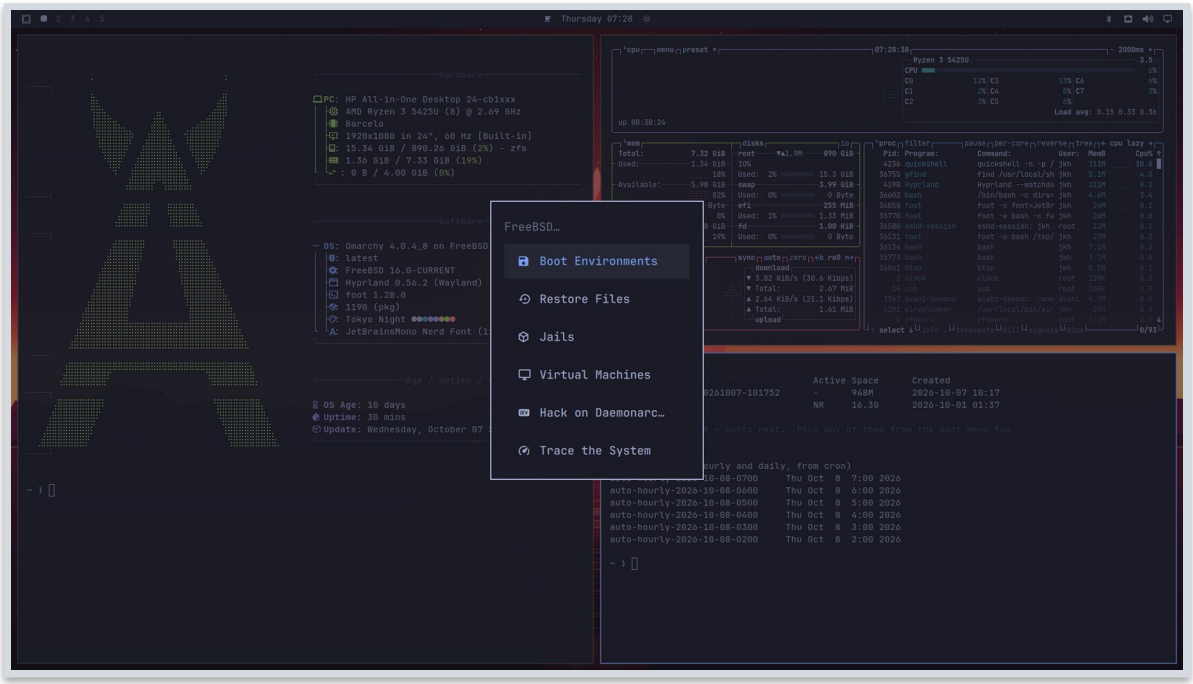
The Omarchy desktop, running on FreeBSD, installed the way the Omarchy ISO installs it on Arch.

Edition for 1.5.1. Describes the published 1.5.0 release (2026-11-04) as documented in the repository; 1.5.1 items are plans, not shipped.

WHAT IT IS

An opinionated desktop on an operating system you can inspect

- **Omarchy's Hyprland desktop**, ported to FreeBSD. The Omarchy software comes unchanged apart from FreeBSD compatibility, from the `x11-wm/omarchy` port.
- **A bootable installer image** with the same welcome, keyboard, account, hostname and timezone questions as the Omarchy ISO.
- **FreeBSD 16.0-CURRENT underneath**, from a snapshot; each image is tied to the snapshot it was built from.
- **Independent.** Not affiliated with or endorsed by Omarchy, the FreeBSD Project or the FreeBSD Foundation.



The Daemonarchy desktop with the System > FreeBSD menu open (docs/images/desktop.png).

Source: README.md (intro, Names and marks)

WHY IT EXISTS

Two projects joined, neither claimed

Daemonarchy is a union of two projects and says so wherever the system describes itself (About reads "Omarchy <version> on FreeBSD <release>").

From Omarchy

- A keyboard-driven Hyprland desktop with one set of opinions.
- The installer's look and its setup form, sourced from Omarchy's own files so the questions and validation are identical.
- Its panels: network, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, sound.

From FreeBSD

- ZFS with boot environments instead of Snapper snapshots.
- Jails, bhyve virtual machines and DTrace.
- Its own network, Wi-Fi (`wpa_supplicant`) and Bluetooth stacks, and the Ports/pkg package collection.

Added by Daemonarchy

- An installer onto a whole disk, a selected GPT partition or free space.
- A signed package feed for what pkg.FreeBSD.org does not publish.
- Original artwork, login theme and the System > FreeBSD menu.

Source: README.md (What FreeBSD adds, The installer, Names and marks)

SAME

What stays the same as FreeBSD

It is FreeBSD, not a reimplementation: your FreeBSD knowledge and tools still apply.

The base system

- FreeBSD 16.0-CURRENT, OSVERSION `1600029` in 1.5.0.
- Base, kernel and 32-bit libraries come from a FreeBSD snapshot's `base.txz`, `kernel.txz` and `lib32.txz`.
- Built from the owned `daemonarchy-src` fork, which tracks upstream and sends useful fixes back.

The tools

- `pkg` and the official FreeBSD package collection: compatible packages come from pkg.FreeBSD.org.
- ZFS, boot environments, jails, bhyve and DTrace.
- Optional shallow `/usr/src` and `/usr/ports` Git checkouts, pinned to the release.

The hardware layer

- FreeBSD's drivers and Wi-Fi stack, with DRM and firmware kernel modules built for the snapshot kernel.
- Bluetooth keyboards and mice through FreeBSD's own stack.
- Linux programs only through FreeBSD's Linuxulator, and only once an exact version is qualified.

Source: README.md (What the image contains, Source); docs/freebsd-application-policy.md

DIFFERENT

What is different from stock FreeBSD

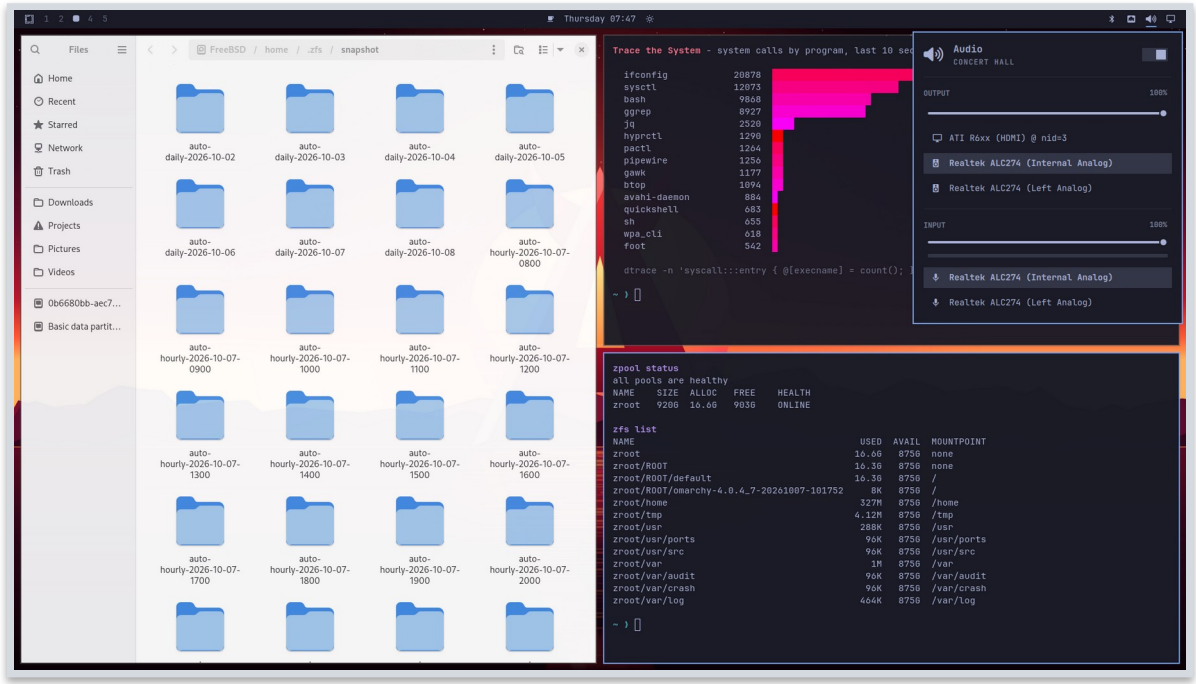
Area	Stock FreeBSD	Daemonarchy
Out of the box	A base system you build a desktop on	A finished Omarchy Hyprland desktop with SDDM, menus, theme and artwork
Installer	bsdinstall	Omarchy-style questions, a network step (packages download at install) and a disk step with optional encryption
Packages	pkg.FreeBSD.org	Also a signed Daemonarchy feed, published as GitHub release assets, with the Omarchy ports and snapshot-built GPU and Wi-Fi modules
Base and kernel source	Upstream FreeBSD	An owned fork, `daemonarchy-src`, pinned by full commit per release
Releases	FreeBSD's schedule	Its own semantic version; each image tied to one CURRENT snapshot
Upgrades	FreeBSD's own tools	`pkg upgrade` updates applications; base and kernel still arrive by a new image (network upgrade is planned for 1.5.1)

Source: README.md; HACKING.md (the upgrade model today); docs/roadmap/release-1.5.1.md

WHAT YOU GET

FreeBSD's strengths, one menu away

- **Boot environments.** Every Omarchy update first saves a bootable copy of the whole system; roll back from the menu or the boot loader.
- **Restore files.** Hourly and daily ZFS snapshots of home directories, kept for a day and a week.
- **Jails and virtual machines.** FreeBSD containers, and bhyve for Linux, Windows or the BSDs.
- **Trace the system** with live DTrace views.
- **Hack on Daemonarchy** from the same menu: fetch the sources and run the desktop from your own checkout.



Home snapshots in Files, a live DTrace view, the ZFS pool and the sound panel (docs/images/freebsd.png).

Source: README.md (What FreeBSD adds)

WHAT SHIPPED

New in 1.5.0, with the evidence stated

The release was re-scoped on 2026-11-03 to work that has evidence.

Windows programs and Steam (amd64)

- Apps menu entries that set up Wine, Wine Mono and DXVK on first launch.
- VERIFIED On a build VM the real first run created the prefix, ran Valve's installer, and Steam updated itself (headless).
- NOT VERIFIED A Windows game or Steam window on real hardware.

Graphical package manager

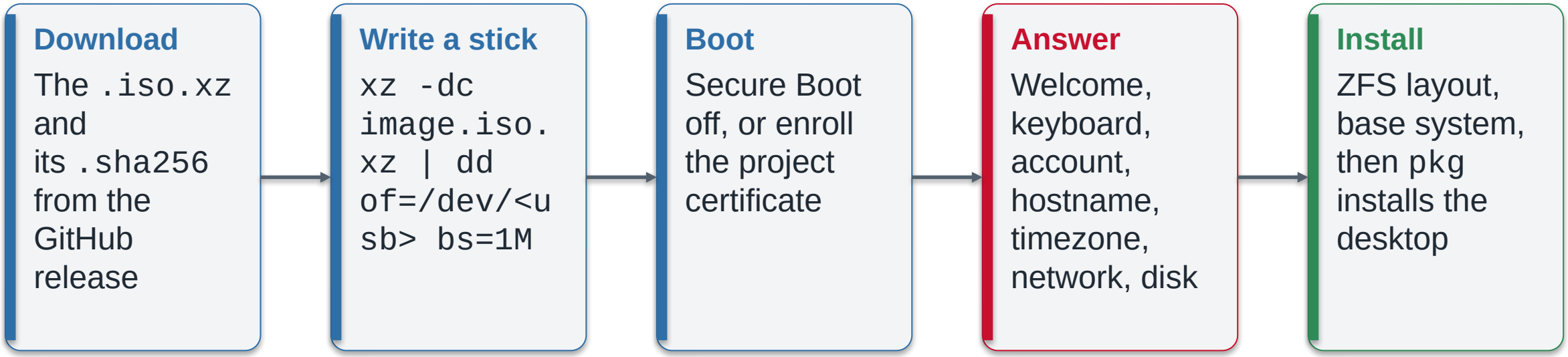
- `daemonarchy-pkg`: a GTK 4 window over the installer's planner, with a plan before every change.
- LIMIT Packaged, but no real-desktop evidence yet; OctoPkg stays the fallback.

Faster login on one machine

- Aquamarine probes connectors only on hotplug.
- VERIFIED MSI Raider 18 HX: login to the shell 2.95 s to 1.32 s warm, from the first version of the patch.
- NOT VERIFIED Hotplug, resume, lid and VT switch.

How it installs

A USB stick, a network connection, and answers to the familiar questions.



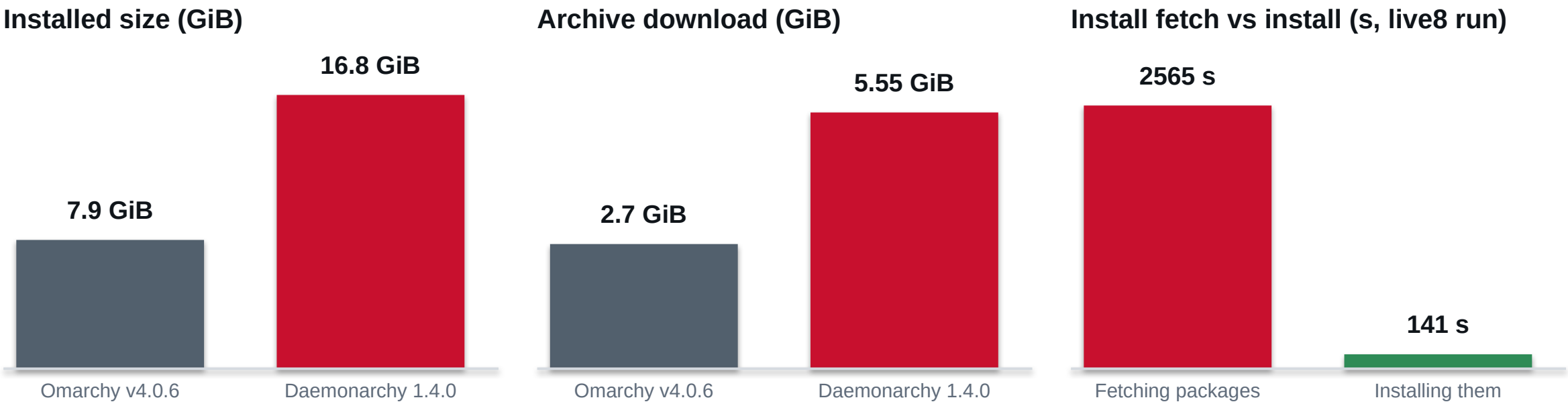
- Whole-disk mode erases the disk; partition mode replaces only the partition you select. The installer needs a network: packages download during the install.
- Unattended installs read answers from a `CIDATA` drive. A console rescue menu and approved remote debugging help when something goes wrong.

Source: README.md (Download, The installer, Unattended installs); docs/getting-started.md; docs/rescue-console.md

HONEST NUMBERS

Install weight: a measured, uncomfortable comparison

Measured at 1.4.0 and recorded in the repository; not re-measured for 1.5.0.



- About 1,189 packages against about 918. Omarchy's ISO carries its whole mirror (6.19 GB); ours is a 1.59 GB `.iso.xz` and the rest comes over the network. Omarchy's "about ten minutes" is its documented figure, not reproduced here.
- Candidates to trim (about 5.3 GiB installed) are listed but not yet removed; 1.4.1 added a parallel package fetch.

Source: docs/install-weight-vs-omarchy.md; docs/release-1.4.1.md

EVIDENCE

What is verified, and what is not

Published does not mean physically qualified. The release notes keep the two apart.

Evidence in hand

- Signed Daemonarchy package feeds, with the public key installed as `daemonarchy.pub`.
- amd64 image (BIOS or UEFI) and its signed Secure Boot bundle published with checksums.
- aarch64 image installs and boots under QEMU with an e1000e NIC (919 archives, about 20 minutes).
- Windows programs first run on a build VM, headless.

Not verified

- Physical runs of the final amd64 image on the MSI Raider 18 HX and the MacBookPro16,1 were not made before publication.
- No Windows game or Steam window on real hardware.
- Wi-Fi and Hyprland on any particular machine: no guarantee.
- Image-based upgrade and rollback; the exact-image network matrix.

Source: docs/release-1.5.0.md (What is not done, Hardware status and limits)

STATUS

Architectures and hardware, plainly

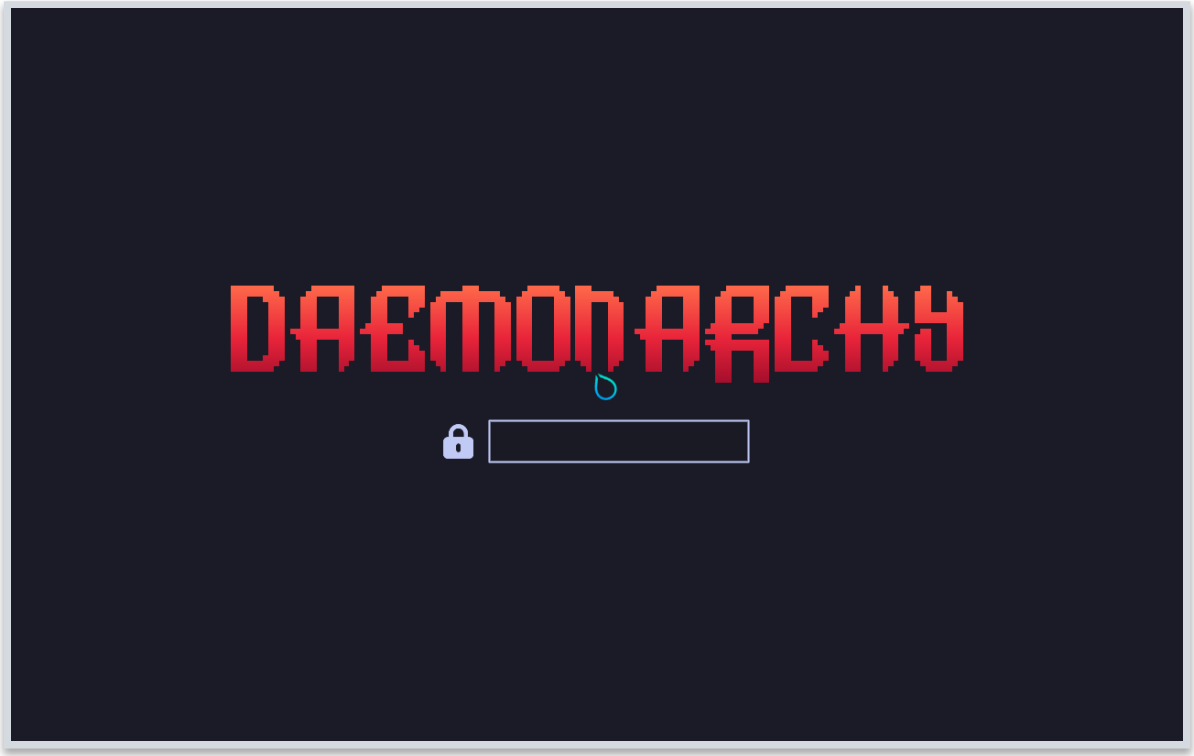
Target	Status	What the repository says
amd64 (BIOS or UEFI)	Published	The primary image. Hardware results are per machine and per build; read the hardware quirks before choosing.
aarch64 (UEFI)	Community validation	Installs and boots in QEMU; a VirtIO GPU path reaches the SDDM greeter and session in software. Known issue: with QEMU's default virtio-net card the install stalls during package fetch, so use an e1000e card. The fix, daemonarchy-src PR #59, is merged and ships in 1.5.1.
NVIDIA RTX Spark laptop	Deferred	The first physical arm64 target: tested, not yet working. The kernel stops starting CPUs; support is deferred and no physical-desktop evidence is claimed.
Apple silicon laptops	Not a target	They cannot be install targets; Macs appear only as QEMU hosts.

Source: docs/release-1.5.0.md; docs/aarch64.md; docs/application-note-rtx-spark.md

COMMUNITY VALIDATION

aarch64 today: it boots in QEMU

- **What was seen:** an installed disk reaching the SDDM greeter and the Omarchy session in software, in QEMU with a VirtIO GPU.
- **What was not:** hardware 3D, a physical GPU, sound, Wi-Fi, upgrade, or the live desktop on real hardware.
- **Help wanted:** if you have arm64 hardware, try it and report the machine, the image SHA-256 and the result. Success reports help as much as failures.



The SDDM greeter in a QEMU guest, software rendering (docs/images/aarch64-qemu-sddm-greeter.png). Not physical hardware.

Trust and updates

Signed by design

- Packages from the Daemonarchy feed are signed; the installer adds its public key.
- amd64 Secure Boot: a signed boot bundle and a published certificate.
- In 1.5.0 no signing key was on a build machine; each release is signed in one planned session.

What `pkg upgrade` does

- Updates applications from the signed feeds, with no new ISO.
- The desktop's Update saves a boot environment first (per the README; implemented in omarchy-freebsd).

What it does not do

- It does not upgrade the base, kernel, loader or trust anchors. No base or kernel feed is published yet.
- Moving to a release that changes the snapshot or kernel still needs the new ISO.

Source: HACKING.md (the upgrade model today); docs/release-1.5.0.md (Upgrading); docs/mastering-1.5.0.md

NEXT

What 1.5.1 plans

Plans, not claims: each item needs retained evidence before it counts as done.

Fix and upgrade

- **PLANNED** The aarch64 virtio-net receive stall fix (daemonarchy-src PR #59) ships.
- **PLANNED** Network upgrade of base, kernel, modules and boot files with boot-environment rollback (NETUP-001), trust rotation (NETUP-002) and upgrade QA (NETUP-003).

Fork and build

- **PLANNED** A fork guide and one configuration for publishing your own installer and feeds (FORK-001).
- **PLANNED** Faster native builds through Literate AI (BUILD-001 and related). No speed-up is claimed today.

Still open

- **LIMIT** RTX Spark laptop support, T2 Touch ID and complete GUI package manager evidence remain open.

Source: docs/roadmap/release-1.5.1.md; docs/release-1.5.0.md

GET STARTED

Try it, report it, help

Daemonarchy is open source under the licenses listed in the repository.

- **Download** the latest release from github.com/jordanhubbard/daemonarchy and read its release notes and hardware limits first.
- **Follow** `docs/getting-started.md`: write the stick, install, and your first hour on the desktop.
- **Report** results with the machine, the image SHA-256 and what you ran. Open an issue on the repository.
- **Hack on it** with the engineering deck and `HACKING.md`: the repository maps its five repositories, the build loop and the release gates.
- **Remember** the limits: Wi-Fi and Hyprland are not guaranteed on any particular machine.

Source: README.md; docs/getting-started.md; docs/aarch64.md (Reporting)